Tersa.ai vs Refly-like App – Detailed Comparison

This report compares Tersa.ai (visual AI workflow builder with broad model integrations) and our Refly-like app (agentic research-to-content workspace with RAG, citations, editor, and journeys).

Positioning

Aspect	Tersa.ai	Refly-like App
Primary Focus	Visual node-based workflows across many AI models (text/image/video/speech)	Research → knowledge → writing pipeline with citations, editor, journeys
Customization	High, via graph composition and many providers	High, via LangGraph journeys and modular services; opinionated UX
Learning Curve	Moderate–high for complex graphs	Low–moderate for content teams

Capabilities

Area	Tersa.ai	Refly-like App
Models/Providers	Broad coverage (hundreds of models/providers)	OpenRouter-backed; extensible, fewer prewired providers today
Canvas	Drag/drop nodes, connect and run workflows	Mind map/outline generator, nodes+edges, knowledge panel, save/templates
Multimedia	Text, images, video, speech pipelines	Text-first; multimedia planned
Knowledge & Search	Depends on node set-up; flexible	File/URL ingest, embeddings, semantic search, citations
Editor	External or node-based generation	Built-in AI assists, citations, MD/HTML export (blocks planned)
Orchestration	Graph execution within the canvas	LangGraph journeys (research/summarize/write)
Workspaces/Auth	Varies by deployment	Workspaces with planned RBAC
Observability	Varies	Logging; LangSmith integration planned

Pros & Cons

	Pros	Cons
Tersa.ai	Broad model support; visual builder; multimedia pipelines	Graph complexity; resource heavy for large flows; content UX not specialized
Refly-like App	Content-centric canvas, RAG + citations, editor, threads, journeys	Fewer provider integrations; multimedia pending; advanced editor/collab pending

Use Cases

Category	Tersa.ai	Refly-like App
Research & Writing	Assemble research pipelines with search/summarize nodes; export to external editors	Ingest sources, semantic search, citations, AI drafting within built-in editor
Technical Docs	Use code analysis and generation nodes; integrate LLMs for explanations	Knowledge-backed drafting, code/diagram generation (Mermaid planned), exports
Data/ML Pipelines	Chain models (embedding, re-rankers), image/video/speech nodes in one graph	Focus on RAG and journeys (search→summarize→write); ext. ML orchestration via LangGraph
Marketing Content	Create multimedia campaigns; generate assets (text, images, video)	Audience research via knowledge, structured briefs, AI writing, citations
Legal/Compliance	Compose checklists/flows; plug in OCR/transcription for evidence handling	Clause extraction (via journeys), tracked citations, structured document templates
Customer Support	Speech-to-text, summarization, response generation pipelines	KB-backed responses, summaries, and artifacted reports
Education & Training	Assemble lesson generators with multimedia outputs	Syllabus outlines, knowledge-backed lessons, handouts with citations
Product/Engineering	Code transformation, doc generation, design-to-asset pipelines	RFCs/PRDs with knowledge context, diagrams, review workflows

Technology Comparison

Layer	Tersa.ai	Refly-like App
Frontend	Visual node/graph builder UI	Angular app: Chat, Canvas, Editor; SVG edges; workspace selector
Orchestration	Graph execution within platform	LangGraph journeys for multi-step flows
LLM Access	Many providers/models integrated	OpenRouter (chat + embeddings); extensible adapters
Storage	Varies by deployment	Postgres + pgvector (semantic), MinIO (files)
Search/RAG	Configurable via nodes	Ingest (files/URLs), embeddings, semantic search, citations
Observability	Platform-specific	Server logs; planned LangSmith tracing
Collaboration	Platform-specific	Planned Yjs CRDT for real-time canvas/editor
Deployment	Open-source; depends on repo	Docker Compose, K8s (planned), env hardening

Recommendations

- Use **Tersa.ai** for general AI workflow IDE needs, especially multimedia and diverse model combos.
- Use the **Refly-like app** for research-to-document pipelines with knowledge retrieval and citations.
- Hybrid: expose Tersa nodes as steps in LangGraph journeys to combine breadth with content UX.

Note: Details are based on publicly available information and our current implementation status; confirm specific enterprise requirements during evaluation.